

To: Prof. Dr. Martin Pawelczyk

Email: martin.pawelczyk@univie.ac.at

Subject: Application for PhD Positions in Responsible AI — Ref 5509 — Nauval Zulfikar

Dear Prof. Dr. Pawelczyk,

I am writing to express my interest in the PhD position in Responsible AI at the Faculty of Computer Science, Universität Wien, under your supervision. I am particularly drawn to your research themes in Data-centric AI and AI Safety, which align closely with my academic background and professional experience. I am available to start on 1 September 2026.

Your work on the Science of Deep Learning, particularly in the context of data efficiency and safety, resonates with my MSc dissertation titled "Enhancing Supply Chain Information Sharing Systems Through Blockchain: Integrated Customer Reviews LLM Analysis." This project involved fine-tuning the DeBERTa-v3 transformer for multi-tier supplier review data, integrating it with Ethereum smart contracts to enhance transparency and data routing efficiency. This experience has equipped me with a robust understanding of transformer models and their application in real-world systems, directly relevant to the themes of your research.

In my role as a Data Scientist & Project Manager at the Public Works & Spatial Planning Department in Bandung, I led initiatives that improved data efficiency by 20% and project delivery speed by 45%. My work involved the design of a production-scheduling system with real-time analytics, which increased planning efficiency by 63%. These projects honed my skills in data governance and the practical application of machine learning in infrastructure environments, aligning with the responsible AI focus of your department.

Additionally, my experience as a Lead Data Scientist at Bank Muamalat Indonesia involved developing NLP models for credit portfolio analysis and risk scoring. This role sparked my interest in post-deployment model behaviour and the technical preconditions of Responsible AI, a key aspect of your research.

I acknowledge that my academic background is in Business Analytics rather than pure Computer Science. However, my MSc program at Aston University provided me with a strong foundation in decision models, software analytics, and effective management consultancy, all of which are pertinent to the interdisciplinary nature of your research.

I have attached my CV, thesis abstract, and transcripts for both my bachelor's and master's degrees for your review. I am eager to contribute to your team and further explore the intersection of AI safety and efficiency.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the possibility of discussing how I can contribute to your research group.

Sincerely,

Nauval Zulfikar

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